

Go-Live Readiness Note

Project: Northstar Support Deflection MVP

Date: August 15, 2026

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Team Members: Jack, Sarah, Mark

Team Name: The Fixers Pod

1. Product Status: Ready for Launch

I am pleased to confirm that the Northstar Support Deflection MVP is fully developed, deployed, and live on GitHub Pages. The prototype successfully meets the minimum viable product requirements to deflect customer support tickets through self-service features.

Specifically, the application successfully handles three primary ticket deflection categories:

- I. Order Tracking: Users can input an Order ID and receive dynamic, color-coded status updates and visual progress bars. A built-in testing guide with preset demo IDs (e.g., ORD-1001, ORD-2002, ORD-3003) is included directly on the UI for seamless evaluation.
- II. Return Processing: Users can initiate a return, select a primary reason, choose a preferred refund method (Original Payment vs. Store Credit), and instantly generate a mock Return Merchandise Authorization (RMA) code.
- III. Instant Policy Help (FAQs): An interactive accordion dynamically serves automated answers to routine policy and shipping questions.
- IV. Technical Fulfillment: The frontend interface correctly integrates with a robust JavaScript-based mock database simulating our backend logic, complete with active error handling for invalid Order IDs. The UI is fully responsive and cleanly formatted using Tailwind CSS.

What's Known-Broken / Missing (MVP Limitations)

- I. Backend Integration: The current logic utilizes a hardcoded JavaScript dictionary (mockDatabase) to validate specific demo IDs and simulate conditions. It is not currently connected to Northstar's live production database.
- II. Stock Availability: While static FAQs address some inventory queries, real-time dynamic stock availability lookups were excluded from this MVP sprint to prioritize the stability of the order tracking and returns infrastructure.
- III. Authentication: The portal operates as an open lookup tool; anyone with a valid Order ID can check its status. There is no email/password verification or user authentication layer implemented yet.

What Northstar Needs to Pick it Up

- I. Your backend engineering team needs to replace the handleOrderLookup() and handleReturnSubmit() functions in the frontend script with actual API calls to your Shopify/Salesforce backend infrastructure.
- II. Host the index.html file on a dedicated support subdomain (e.g., help.northstar-retail.com).

2. Process & Compliance Sign-Off

As Team Lead, I have reviewed our Sprint execution and verify the following team agreements were met:

- The 4-Hour Rule: No single task on our project board exceeded 4 hours of active work. Tasks were properly scoped.
- Board Accuracy: The project board accurately reflects reality. Team members adhered to the rule of moving their task cards to the appropriate column (To Do, In Progress, Done) on the exact same day the work was completed.
- Audit Log Integrity: All code was collaboratively integrated into the index.html file via GitHub commits, ensuring our exported Audit Log accurately timestamps the entire sequence of development.